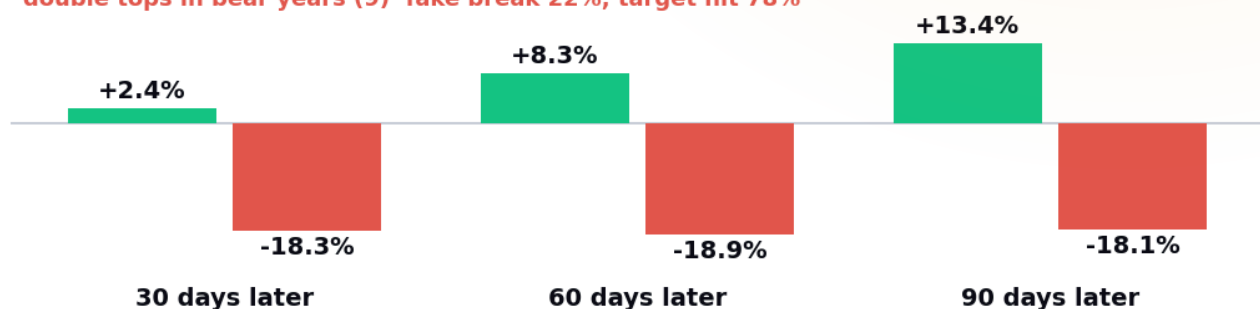


THE TOP PATTERN STUDY

Every double top and rounding top on Bitcoin since 2012, found by a fixed rule, graded at 30, 60 and 90 days against any random day.

The measured-move hit rate, the fake-break rate, bull years against bear years, and the September 2026 pattern that one crowd called a double top and another called a rounding top.

double tops in bull years (18) fake break 72%, target hit 39%
double tops in bear years (9) fake break 22%, target hit 78%



Bitcoin after every confirmed double top since 2012, split by the year's regime.

29

confirmed double tops since 2012

59%

closed back above the neckline within a week

-18%

90 days later in bear years, against +13% in bull years

Educational, not financial advice. The patterns are found by rule, not by eye, so the count includes every case the rule catches and none it does not. Nine bear-year cases is a small sample and is treated as one.



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THE RULES

HOW A TOP WAS FOUND, AND HOW IT WAS GRADED

Double top. Two swing highs, each the highest high in an eleven-day window, 10 to 60 days apart and within 3% of each other. The lowest low between them is the neckline, and it has to sit at least 5% under the lower of the two highs, so a flat range does not count. The pattern is confirmed on the first daily close below the neckline within 30 days of the second high. Highs and lows are wicks. One signal per 30 days.

Rounding top. A 20, 30 or 40 day window whose closes fit a concave-down parabola with an R-squared of 0.75 or better, the peak inside the middle half of the window and at least 5% above both ends. The neckline is the close at the start of the window. Confirmed on the first close below it within 15 days of the window ending.

The grades. For every confirmed pattern, the close 30, 60 and 90 days after confirmation against the same horizons from every day since 2012. The measured move is the textbook target, the neckline minus the pattern height, and counts as hit if any daily low touches it within 60 days. A fake break is a daily close back above the neckline within 7 days of the confirmation. Bull years are 2013, 2016, 2017, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2023, 2024 and 2025. Bear years are 2014, 2015, 2018, 2022 and 2026.

THE COUNT

29 double tops and 44 rounding tops in fourteen years. Relaxing the minimum gap between highs from 10 days to 5 adds six double tops and does not change the split, bull-year fake breaks 78%, bear-year 30%.

THE SCOREBOARD

THE PATTERN AGAINST ANY DAY

PATTERN	N	+30D / HIGHER	+60D / HIGHER	+90D / HIGHER	TARGET HIT	FAKE BREAK
double tops, all	29	+0.4% / 52%	+0.8% / 59%	+10.1% / 55%	52%	59%
double tops, bull years	18	+2.4% / 61%	+8.3% / 72%	+13.4% / 67%	39%	72%
double tops, bear years	9	-18.3% / 22%	-18.9% / 22%	-18.1% / 22%	78%	22%
rounding tops, all	44	+0.6% / 55%	+1.6% / 52%	+4.3% / 53%	73%	41%
any day	5,344	+3.0% / 57%	+7.1% / 58%	+9.6% / 59%		

Medians. 'higher' = share of cases with a higher close. Target hit within 60 days on daily lows. Fake break = close back above the neckline within 7 days.

On its own the double top predicted nothing. Thirty days after the break Bitcoin was a median +0.4%, higher 52% of the time, a coin flip. Ninety days after, +10.1% against +9.6% for any random 90 days. The measured move got hit 52% of the time, and 59% of confirmed breaks closed back above the neckline inside a week. More than half of every confirmed break was a fake break.

Split by the year and the same pattern gives opposite answers. In bull years, 18 cases, price was +13.4% ninety days later and 72% of breaks were fakes. In bear years, 9 cases, price was -18.1% and 78% hit the measured move. The regime decided the outcome. The shape did not.

DOUBLE TOPS

ALL 29 CONFIRMED DOUBLE TOPS, 2012 TO 2021

CONFIRMED	TOP	NECKLINE	HEIGHT	+30D	+60D	+90D	TARGET HIT 60D	FAKE BREAK 7D
25 Mar 2012	\$5	\$5	15%	+12%	+13%	+42%	no	yes
21 Oct 2012	\$13	\$12	13%	+3%	+18%	+36%	yes	yes
02 Oct 2013	\$129	\$121	6%	+95%	+820%	+605%	yes	yes
13 Aug 2014	\$616	\$554	11%	-14%	-31%	-32%	yes	no
13 Apr 2015	\$268	\$228	18%	+6%	+3%	+39%	no	no
15 Jan 2016	\$468	\$403	16%	+12%	+16%	+18%	no	yes
02 Aug 2016	\$705	\$606	16%	+6%	+14%	+29%	no	no
09 Mar 2018	\$11,780	\$9,260	27%	-24%	-1%	-17%	yes	yes
11 May 2018	\$9,949	\$8,647	15%	-19%	-25%	-22%	yes	yes
14 Nov 2018	\$6,756	\$6,055	12%	-43%	-37%	-36%	yes	no
13 Jan 2019	\$4,237	\$3,566	19%	+2%	+10%	+44%	no	yes
24 Sep 2019	\$11,120	\$9,111	22%	-13%	-14%	-14%	yes	no
08 Mar 2020	\$9,219	\$8,213	12%	-10%	+24%	+20%	yes	no
03 Sep 2020	\$12,100	\$10,560	15%	+4%	+34%	+89%	no	no
24 Apr 2021	\$61,782	\$50,360	23%	-23%	-33%	-33%	yes	yes
21 Sep 2021	\$48,834	\$42,900	14%	+53%	+47%	+16%	no	yes
22 Nov 2021	\$69,000	\$56,425	22%	-14%	-35%	-32%	yes	yes

Height = top over neckline. Target = neckline minus height, hit if a daily low touched it within 60 days.

The 2018 cluster is the pattern working as advertised, three confirmed tops that all fell to target inside a bear. The 2013, 2016 and 2020 cases are the pattern failing as it usually fails in a bull, a confirmed break that reclaimed the neckline within days and ran. Same rule, same chart, opposite year.

DOUBLE TOPS

ALL 29 CONFIRMED DOUBLE TOPS, 2022 TO 2026

CONFIRMED	TOP	NECKLINE	HEIGHT	+30D	+60D	+90D	TARGET HIT 60D	FAKE BREAK 7D
05 May 2022	\$42,979	\$37,567	14%	-18%	-45%	-37%	yes	no
26 Aug 2022	\$24,676	\$20,700	19%	-7%	-1%	-18%	no	no
09 Nov 2022	\$20,381	\$18,183	12%	+8%	+8%	+46%	yes	no
24 May 2023	\$30,022	\$26,541	13%	+17%	+14%	-1%	no	yes
24 Jul 2023	\$31,500	\$29,508	7%	-9%	-9%	+3%	yes	no
22 Jan 2024	\$45,922	\$40,181	14%	+31%	+61%	+64%	no	yes
30 Apr 2024	\$73,794	\$60,760	22%	+13%	+0%	+10%	no	yes
07 Jul 2024	\$72,756	\$56,500	29%	+0%	+1%	+11%	no	yes
25 Feb 2025	\$106,447	\$89,164	19%	-2%	+7%	+24%	no	yes
25 Aug 2025	\$124,517	\$111,919	11%	+3%	+1%	-21%	no	yes
17 Oct 2025	\$126,272	\$107,270	18%	-12%	-17%	-10%	yes	yes
30 Jan 2026	\$94,792	\$84,398	12%	-22%	-19%	-9%	yes	no

The January 2026 double top is this bear's own case, broke and fell 22% in a month.

2024 and early 2025 printed five confirmed double tops in a row that all reclaimed within a week, the bull-year fake break at its most extreme. Then October 2025 and January 2026 both held their breaks and hit target, which is what the pattern does once the regime turns. The pattern did not get better. The year changed.

ROUNDING TOPS

ALL 44 ROUNDING TOPS, FIRST HALF

CONFIRMED	TOP	NECKLINE	HEIGHT	+30D	+90D	TARGET HIT 60D	FAKE BREAK 7D
26 Oct 2012	\$13	\$11	23%	+23%	+73%	no	yes
09 Jun 2013	\$131	\$107	22%	-25%	+20%	yes	yes
18 Dec 2013	\$1,163	\$536	117%	+53%	+18%	no	yes
16 Feb 2014	\$827	\$752	10%	-1%	-28%	yes	no
14 Jun 2014	\$683	\$574	19%	+10%	-16%	no	yes
01 Nov 2014	\$418	\$326	28%	+16%	-29%	no	yes
11 Dec 2014	\$395	\$351	12%	-21%	-15%	yes	yes
16 Apr 2015	\$263	\$248	6%	+4%	+26%	yes	no
10 Aug 2015	\$297	\$277	8%	-10%	+41%	yes	no
15 Jan 2016	\$468	\$363	29%	+12%	+18%	no	yes
06 Aug 2016	\$684	\$638	7%	+2%	+19%	yes	no
18 Mar 2017	\$1,298	\$1,055	23%	+21%	+156%	no	yes
16 Jul 2017	\$2,639	\$2,421	9%	+117%	+203%	yes	yes
15 Sep 2017	\$4,980	\$4,333	15%	+54%	+343%	yes	no
19 Jan 2018	\$17,235	\$12,640	36%	-10%	-28%	yes	yes
18 Mar 2018	\$11,688	\$10,325	13%	-4%	-21%	yes	no
18 May 2018	\$9,949	\$9,345	6%	-22%	-23%	yes	no
17 Jun 2018	\$7,791	\$7,112	10%	+13%	+1%	yes	no
10 Aug 2018	\$8,497	\$6,244	36%	+2%	+4%	no	yes
10 Sep 2018	\$7,412	\$6,479	14%	+3%	-44%	no	yes
21 Nov 2018	\$6,756	\$6,185	9%	-15%	-14%	yes	no
28 Aug 2019	\$12,325	\$9,764	26%	-16%	-26%	no	yes

Found by curve fit on 20, 30 and 40 day windows. Neckline = the close at the window start.

ROUNDING TOPS

ALL 44 ROUNDING TOPS, SECOND HALF

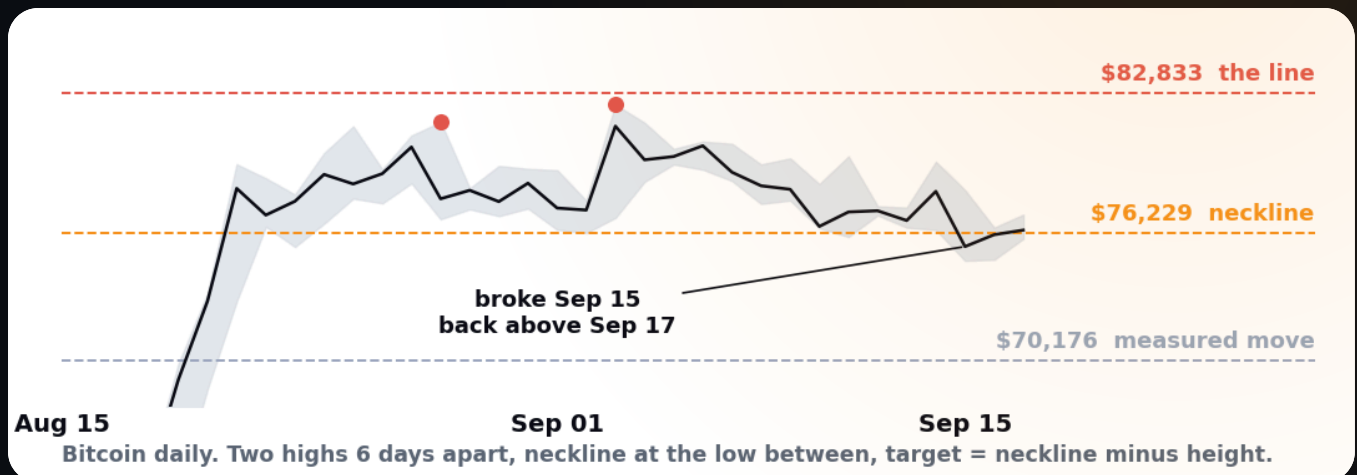
CONFIRMED	TOP	NECKLINE	HEIGHT	+30D	+90D	TARGET HIT 60D	FAKE BREAK 7D
25 Nov 2019	\$10,350	\$7,996	29%	+1%	+40%	no	no
19 Mar 2020	\$9,219	\$8,704	6%	+17%	+53%	yes	no
11 Sep 2020	\$12,473	\$11,072	13%	+9%	+76%	no	no
25 Apr 2021	\$64,895	\$59,125	10%	-22%	-30%	yes	no
25 May 2021	\$59,603	\$49,128	21%	-10%	+29%	yes	no
07 Dec 2021	\$69,000	\$60,593	14%	-15%	-25%	yes	no
27 Jan 2022	\$44,456	\$41,536	7%	+5%	+6%	yes	no
11 Apr 2022	\$48,234	\$41,794	15%	-27%	-47%	yes	no
11 May 2022	\$42,979	\$39,525	9%	+0%	-20%	yes	no
15 Jun 2022	\$32,376	\$29,183	11%	-8%	-11%	yes	no
31 Aug 2022	\$25,212	\$23,283	8%	-3%	-18%	yes	no
14 Nov 2022	\$21,473	\$20,087	7%	+7%	+31%	yes	no
11 Mar 2023	\$25,270	\$21,802	16%	+44%	+28%	no	yes
13 May 2023	\$30,022	\$27,596	9%	-3%	+10%	yes	no
24 Jun 2024	\$71,958	\$62,320	16%	+9%	+5%	yes	yes
06 Aug 2024	\$70,016	\$64,091	9%	+0%	+21%	yes	no
24 Feb 2025	\$109,356	\$94,702	16%	-5%	+19%	yes	no
26 Sep 2025	\$117,968	\$110,223	7%	+4%	-21%	yes	yes
07 Nov 2025	\$116,381	\$107,220	8%	-12%	-39%	yes	no
02 Feb 2026	\$97,939	\$90,590	8%	-8%	-0%	yes	no
22 May 2026	\$82,833	\$76,323	8%	-16%	-3%	yes	yes
28 Jun 2026	\$67,253	\$63,062	7%	+7%		yes	yes

The May 2026 rounding top peaked at \$82,833, the bear's last lower high, and fell 16% in a month.

The rounding top hit its measured move 73% of the time, which sounds like a working pattern until you look at the size of the move. The median arc is 12% tall, so its target sits only that far under the neckline and an ordinary dip reaches it. Ninety days later the median rounding top was +4.3%, higher 53% of the time. A pattern that hits its target while price ends up flat is not a bearish pattern. It is a description of a wobble.

THE LIVE CASE

SEPTEMBER 2026, THE PATTERN WITH TWO NAMES



Highs at \$81,455 on 28 August and \$82,281 on 3 September, six days apart, both under the \$82,833 lower high that has defined this bear's structure since May. The lowest low between them was \$76,229 on 2 September, which is the neckline, and the same level the 4-hour chart crowd drew. The measured move is \$70,176, the 70K everyone quoted. The pattern confirmed on the 15 September close at \$75,577, closed back above the neckline on 17 September, and was trading above \$80,000 on 18 September.

By the strict rule the two highs are four days too close, so this is admitted under the 5-day version, which gives the same split. A reclaim within two days is what 72% of bull-year breaks did and 22% of bear-year breaks. 2026's own record leans the other way, the January double top and the May rounding top both held their breaks and hit target. This is the first break this year that reclaimed.

THE TEST

This is a study, not a call. Below \$82,833 on a daily and weekly close the bear-year rows apply, and bear-year breaks held 7 of 9 times. Above it the bull-year rows apply, and 72% of breaks were fakes. Watch the neckline at \$76,229 and the line at \$82,833, not the pattern's name.

WHAT THIS STUDY DOES NOT SAY

Nine bear-year double tops. The bull-versus-bear split is the finding of this study and its smallest sample. Nine cases can describe a lean, not a law, and the bull-year cases are also the ones with the most overlapping rallies.

The rule is one rule. A 3% match, a 5% dip, a daily close. Change any of them and the count changes. The 5-day gap check is printed because the live case needed it, and it did not change the answer, but a rule that catches the pattern you are looking at is a rule you should be suspicious of.

Rounding tops are a curve fit. An R-squared threshold on a parabola is one way to define a shape people draw by hand, and there is no standard. The rounding-top rows are there so the pattern being shared has a measured record, not because the definition is settled.

Regime is defined by the calendar year. That is crude and it is honest, because it cannot be tuned. The structural definition this page uses in practice is the \$82,833 line, and the two mostly agree in 2026.

Data pinned 18 September 2026. Bitstamp BTC/USD daily bars from 2012, wicks for highs and lows. Scripts: DoubleTop/dt_study.py, dt_charts.py. This is education, not financial advice.

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